



Hybrid Choppers!

The Eurocopter X3 is among the earliest of a new breed of high-speed hybrid helicopters <http://bit.ly/pRanUD>

DOTA 2

DOTA 2 is currently under development. Surprisingly, Valve will develop it using the source engine <http://bit.ly/pQ1hl5>

A look at Web Intents – the future of the web ecosystem

Web Intents are the next big thing to come to the open web, and stand to not only change the way we interact with web applications, but also the way web applications interact with each other

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Disconnected islands

It's difficult to refute that the web has made the world a much more connected place. Information is now at our fingertips, no matter where we are, as long as we have any device with internet connectivity.

The irony is that the model of the web has created as much disconnection. No, we're not taking a philosophical stand by saying that we're now less personally connected because we're connected through inhuman machines. Our stand is technical, so let us explain.

The web used to be an interconnection of documents, and hyperlinks were well suited for the purpose, however now the model of the web has transitioned to that of web applications. Hyperlinks are no longer enough; neither is it enough to simply launch an online social network by clicking on a share link if one wants to share content as well. For this purpose, each social network has its own solutions, but there's no general solution, and links just aren't enough anymore.

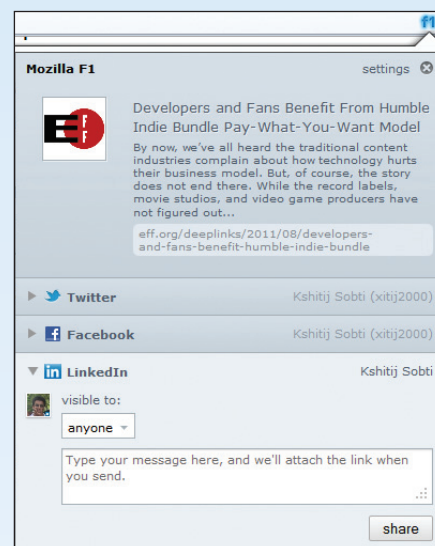
The web is quickly encroaching on areas traditionally covered only by native applications. Sure, web-based email clients are old, but today we have everything from advanced photo editors to 3D modeling applications. Many of them connect to social networks, allowing you to easily share your work with friends. Google Docs, for example, lets you share documents, and work with others in real time; web applications like LucidChart do the same for diagrams while Aviary's

image and audio editing / processing tools let one create, share and remix photos. But is it really as connected as it appears to be?

The web has turned into small islands of connectivity; within these islands, you might get a seamless experience, but stray outside and things start going downhill. For example, Google Pikknik lets you open images from your Picasa, Facebook, Flickr, MySpace or Photobucket accounts and even save back to them; but what if you're using SmugMug? Or something even less mainstream such as Ipernity or Phombo?

The desktop paradigm

Compare this to the non-web alternative; your flash drive will work on your computer regardless of the brand. Motherboards aren't pre-programmed to



Mozilla F1 is an example of how the new system might work with social networking. Only associated social networks show up here.

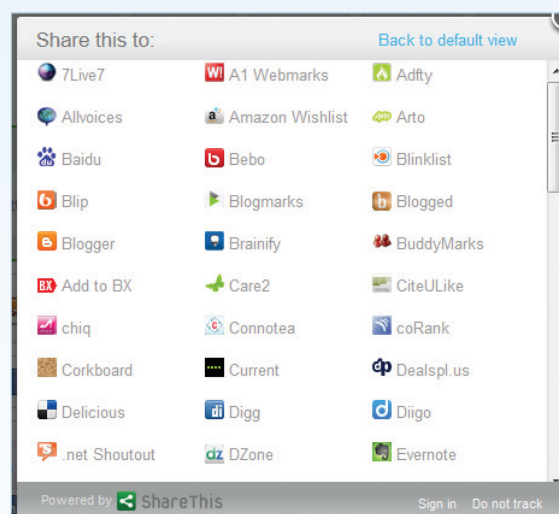
support a few brands of storage drives, nor are DVD burners programmed for each brand of media. They just work.

If you wanted to use a SmugMug photo in Pikknik however, you'd have to first download it to your hard drive (or

possibly use a URL pointing to the image), open that image in Pikknik, edit it, download the result and re-upload to SmugMug.

There are innumerable combinations of applications and services that are incompatible. For an image editing service it's an insurmountable task to implement support for each storage service – each using different APIs for pretty much the same tasks.

Take another example: sharing on social networks. Here, we see an extreme; either web sites ignore the more obscure social web sites



An overload of buttons. It can be hard to locate the social network you use here.